

Internet Research

CISC 1050 — CUNY Brooklyn College

Lecture Notes



These notes by [Miriam Briskman](#) are licensed under [CC BY-NC 4.0](#) and based on [sources](#).

In the “Intro to Computers” chapter, our discussion chiefly focused on creating and finding information (and files) on our own computer. We shouldn’t, however, limit ourselves only to our single device.

Internet Research refers to the activity of searching and detecting information online.

Research purposes include:

1. Finding the definition of a word, phrase, or concept (e.g., a search for the definition of the English word “Taradiddle” or the explanation of what “Laissez-faire” is.)
2. Detecting online research papers, news articles, or other publications on a specific topic (e.g., a search for an article on the effects of Covid-19 vaccines on pregnancy.)
3. Locating images, audio, and video files related to a topic (e.g., searching for cooking videos or streams on YouTube or searching for images of flowers on Google.)



In this lecture, we talk about what browsers are and bring up some examples of widely used browsers, discuss how internet research is conducted, explain how to search for images online, and learn what advanced search tools could be used to refine internet search.

Internet Browsers

The **Internet** (or **World Wide Web**) is a network globally interconnecting most computers.

A **browser** (or **web browser**) is a program that connects your computer to the internet.



Browsers

4

Examples of popular browsers include:

Browser Name	Creator	Logo	Download & Info Link
Google Chrome	Google		https://www.google.com/chrome/
Mozilla Firefox	Mozilla Foundation	 or 	https://www.mozilla.org/en-US/
Microsoft Edge	Microsoft	 or 	https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/edge
Safari	Apple		https://www.apple.com/safari/
Opera	Opera		https://www.opera.com/



- **Microsoft Edge** is shipped with the Windows operating system. In other words, it isn't needed to be installed.
- **Safari** is shipped with the Mac operating system. You can also find it on your other Apple devices: iPhones, iPads, etc.
- **Google Chrome**, **Mozilla Firefox**, or **Opera** might be already installed on your computer or on your organization's computers. If they aren't installed, use the links in the table above to download them to your computer, regardless of what operating system it has.

Where can I find the browser?

There are a few places to search for a browser's logo:

1. Using your computer's search bar is the fastest way to find your desired browser's logo.
2. In the Start Menu: Click the Start button, and search for the browser in the app menu.
3. On the Desktop or on the Dock: When a browser is installed, its logo is usually automatically added to the Desktop, so try searching for it there, too.



How can I open a browser?

Once you see the logo of the browser you searched for, **click**, or **double-click** it to open it.

Well, what browser should you use?

It's your choice! Choose your browser based on how convenient you feel using it, how familiar you are with the browser, etc. Each browser also has its own advantages. For instance, some browsers are faster than others, like Google Chrome, and some browsers focus on keeping your information private, like Mozilla Firefox.

Basic Browser Tools

Each browser feature various buttons and input boxes that can be used to navigate from one webpage to another, or to ease the navigation and search process.



These notes by [Miriam Briskman](#) are licensed under [CC BY-NC 4.0](#) and based on [sources](#).

Most browsers have:

1. Back and Forth arrow buttons → to move to the previous or next page.
2. Refresh Button → to refresh the page and check if any changes were made to it.
3. New Tab Button → to open another tab (in which you can search for or navigate to another page.)
4. Address Bar → to type a link (also known as URL) of a webpage and move to it.
5. Resizing and Closing Buttons → to change the browser window's size or close the browser.
6. Menu Button → to change the browser's settings, see all previously visited pages (browsing history), view the browser's info (version), etc.



Hyperlinks

8

Hyperlinks are pieces of text, usually, blue-colored, that, if clicked, automatically navigate to the webpage to which they connect. An example of a hyperlink is <https://www.google.com/>, which lead to the Google search page.

Suppose you just sat next to a computer that has some browser window open, but you can remember/recognize which one browser it is. You can find what browser you are using by going to a website like <https://www.whatsmybrowser.org/> that will display the browser's name and even version number!

We will talk more about hyperlinks, including how to create them and change them when needed, and what objects we can create hyperlinks for, when we cover the Microsoft Word app.



These notes by [Miriam Briskman](#) are licensed under [CC BY-NC 4.0](#) and based on [sources](#).

Hyperlinks

9

Any questions so far?



These notes by [Miriam Briskman](#) are licensed under [CC BY-NC 4.0](#) and based on [sources](#).

Internet research should be **ethical**. That is, all research should respect each involved person, made safe, be well designed (have a clear purpose,) and be fair.

Each company creates (and should create) guidelines for its employees for what constitutes an ethical search, so make sure to consult these guidelines.

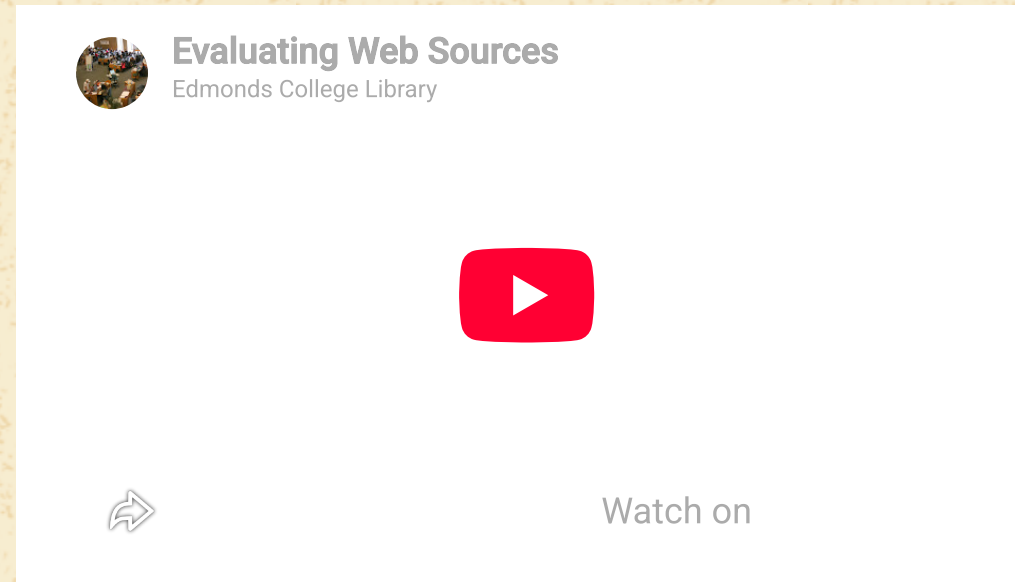
Doing your research ethically has both social and business-related benefits. On the other hand, unethical research can lead to negative social, business, and even legal consequences. For example, there are data and customer rights that unethical research can violate. Most countries have legislation against the usage of personal information without the person's consent.



Basic Searches

11

First, let's watch a short video about internet searches:



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bYCh8Tc7Xwc>



These notes by [Miriam Briskman](#) are licensed under [CC BY-NC 4.0](#) and based on [sources](#).

Basic Searches

After you opened a browser, you usually navigate to a **search engine**, which is a website where you can search the Internet.

Here are some search engine examples:

Search Engine Name	Logo	Link
Google		https://www.google.com/
Bing		https://www.bing.com/
Yahoo		https://www.yahoo.com/
Ask.com		https://www.ask.com/
AOL.com		https://www.aol.com/



For the HW 2 assignment, you will use Google to make a single search.

Fun Class Activity: Let's use [Google](#) to search the following: "winter boots".

When doing the search, answer the following questions.

1. How many search results were found in total?
2. Are there any advertisements displayed on the right-hand side?
3. How many of the search results at the top of the page are ads?
4. What is the name of the 1st webpage that is not an ad?
5. What is the 1st item among the "Related searches"?
6. What is the name of the 1st news article on "winter boots", and what website posted it?
7. (Fun Question:) How many O's does the word Google at the bottom of the page have?



Any questions so far?



Keywords and Special Symbols

Besides just searching for a pure set of words, you can refine the search using a few techniques that involve special keywords or symbols:

Keyword / Symbol	Purpose	Example
AND	Results containing both items	pizza AND cola
OR	Results containing either or both/all items	England OR Ireland
NOT	Results excluding the phrase/word that follows	college NOT community
- (minus sign)	Results excluding the phrase/word that follows	college -community
" " (quotations)	Results containing exactly this phrase	"red jelly beans"
* (asterisk)	Results with various characters in place of *	*th grade exams
() (parentheses)	Results with imposed order	(red OR sore) AND gums



Google-specific search options, like `site:`, can be found here: <https://support.google.com/websearch/answer/2466433?hl=en>.

Searching Images

Browsers allow you to search for images, and search *with* images!

On Google, you can:

- Search for an item, and then click the “Images” tab to see all detected images.
- Click on the small image icon:  to search the Internet using an image:
 - By pasting the URL of an image, or
 - By uploading an image.

Google will then ‘translate’ the image into words and search them!



Any questions?



Internet Research: Sources

Briskman, Miriam. "[Lecture Notes: Internet Research](#)." Updated 21 Aug. 2023. Word Document. License: [CC BY-NC: Attribution-NonCommercial](#).

[Module 2: Internet Research](#). Authored by: Sherri Pendleton. Provided by: Lumen Learning. License: [CC BY: Attribution](#).

Note: Unless otherwise noted, all images and documents embedded in these lecture notes were created by Miriam Briskman and are licensed [CC BY-NC: Attribution-NonCommercial](#).



These notes by [Miriam Briskman](#) are licensed under [CC BY-NC 4.0](#) and based on [sources](#).